



“Technology can be an enabler but the problem in today’s world is that everyone thinks that technology is the solution to all the problems of our lives. It isn’t. Technology is not a magic pill. Aadhaar, for instance, is a great enabler”

NITHIN KAMATH

FOUNDER & CEO,
ZERODHA



“Algos will definitely be more widely adopted by retail investors as a part of their overall portfolio; it will, however, require continued and evolving regulations to ensure safeguards for retail allocation”

VASANTH KAMATH

FOUNDER &
CEO, SMALLCASE



“Innovations like fractional trading that makes equity ownership frictionless, and tokenised real estate that provides a simple way to buy and hold a diversified real estate portfolio can help Indian investors”

GAURAV RASTOGI

FOUNDER,
Kuvera



“Patterns rhyme across the globe. As the US went from a \$3-trillion to \$10-trillion economy, the participation of investments moved from 3 per cent of the population to 50 per cent...We expect the same pattern to rhyme in India”

AMIT JESWANI

FOUNDER,
STALLION ASSET

math, Founder & CEO of Zerodha, which has become the country’s largest broking firm in terms of the number of active clients.

“India needs a professional advisory ecosystem with tens of thousands of advisors. A lot of robo-advisory businesses have not really gone anywhere. People don’t trust a push notification or a mobile app to tell them what to do. People need that trust to be built by talking to people. A human who is dispensing advice can leverage machines but that human-to-human interaction will always be required for people to act on money decisions,” he explains.

Kuvera’s Rastogi, however, believes that the biggest risk for the retail investor is the mis-selling of financial products, and technology can reduce that risk considerably.

“Is it easier to mis-sell a financial product in a one-on-one conversation where the distributor gets a

commission or through a large tech-driven platform where everything is scrutinised by the most financially savvy amongst the platform’s user base?” asks Rastogi whose platform has around 1.6 million users.

Interestingly, no deep dive into future trends can be complete without talking about technology and disruption, and the capital markets are no different.

The last decade or so has seen technology disrupt many aspects of the trading and investing arena with discount broking firms snatching away market share from traditional players and investing experience becoming totally seamless.

The coming decades are expected to further ride on the tech bandwagon with trading apps becoming smarter and feature-rich.

“Investing apps do not exist in a vacuum. If we move towards a voice-based interface, investing apps will

follow. If we move towards an AR/VR-based interface, investing apps will follow,” says Rastogi.

The markets will certainly evolve and mature as time passes, but as India moves steadily towards its 100 years of independence, one area that requires special attention is that of financial education and literacy and if the concepts of saving, investing and financial planning are introduced at the school level, then the coming decades would definitely see a stronger and more resilient capital market.

“Money and relationships are the two most important determining factors of our life. Concepts related to saving, investing and retirement planning, among other things, should be introduced in school. It will do good for the country if it is introduced early,” says Zerodha’s Kamath. **BT**

@ashishrukhaiyar